SAMPLE DOCUMENT

Agent Response Review

Late-order example: what went wrong, and a better reply

Scenario

A customer writes: “Where is my order? It should have arrived last week.” Below, a weak reply and a stronger one.

BEFORE: weak reply	AFTER: better reply
Hello. Your order is delayed because of the carrier. This is not our fault. Please wait. Regards.	Hi [Name], I’m sorry your order is late. I know how frustrating it is to wait. I checked order [Order #]: the carrier shows it left the local hub on [date], and the new estimated delivery is [date]. I will check again on [date]. If it has not arrived by then, I will arrange a replacement or refund, your choice. Reply here any time and I will help right away. Kind regards, [Agent]

What is wrong with the weak reply

- No apology - The customer feels ignored.
- Blames the carrier - Sounds defensive and unhelpful.
- No next step or date - The customer still does not know what happens next.
- No order check shown - Feels like a copied answer.
- Closes the door - Nothing invites the customer to reply.

Criteria	Weak reply	Better reply
Empathy	1 / 5	5 / 5
Accuracy	3 / 5	5 / 5
Next step	1 / 5	5 / 5
Ownership	1 / 5	5 / 5
Tone	2 / 5	5 / 5

TIP: Teach agents the order: sorry - what I checked - what happens next - how to reach me.